Laundry, Solved

Take one load from dirty clothes to its actual home.

01 Choose the load and protect the time

Have machine access or a handwashing plan, compatible detergent, a basket, drying space or dryer, and somewhere to put clean clothes. Check machine availability and cycle lengths, then allow time to transfer, dry and put away. If a supply or home is missing, arrange it before starting.

02 Sort by care requirements

Read the item labels first. Group only clothes that can use the same wash and drying method. Separate items requiring handwashing, dry cleaning, a colorfastness check or other special treatment. Keep heavily soiled items apart where their instructions require it. You do not need a fixed number of piles.

Choose one compatible group for this session. Other groups remain visible jobs for later; they are not part of this load's finish.

03 Treat stains as directed

Check the fabric's care label and a suitable treatment's instructions, including any test on a hidden area. Avoid improvised solvent mixtures. Recheck a stain before machine drying; if it remains, follow the treatment directions again rather than assuming heat will remove it.

04 Load, dose and start

Follow the washer's capacity and loading instructions. Select a cycle and temperature permitted by the clothes. Use detergent compatible with the machine, measuring the labeled dose for the load, soil and water conditions. Put pods or liquid only where the product and machine instructions say.

Set a reminder for the actual cycle end. A cold cycle may suit many ordinary garments, but the care label and machine instructions decide for this load.

05 Transfer to the right drying method

Check stains, then dry each item as its label directs. Some need flat or air drying; do not substitute machine drying for a care restriction. For a dryer, clean the lint filter before use and follow loading and cycle instructions. Be available to check and remove the load.

If drying is taking unexpectedly long, check the instructions and arrange maintenance when needed. Do not assume the cause or keep restarting an overheating machine.

06 Put the dry clothes away

Check that items are dry. Hang or fold them and put them in their known homes before starting another load. Use existing hangers and drawer space. If storage is full, record and solve that capacity problem; clothes left in the basket are not a put-away load.

07 If you use a laundromat

Check opening hours, payment, machine availability and posted instructions. Bring detergent, baskets, payment and the clothes. Include travel, waiting, washing, drying and the return home in your plan. Parallel machines may help when available, but they do not establish a one-hour finish. Set reminders and remain available to transfer and collect the load.

> **THE FINISH:**
> the chosen load is dry and stored, machines are left as instructed, and supplies are put away. A later load is a separate session. If an item still needs treatment or drying, record it as unfinished.

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